



LIST OF CLINICAL SYMBOLS

Clinical symbols are standardized marks and notations used alongside abbreviations in medical documentation to convey instructions, measurements, and clinical observations quickly and precisely. This reference compiles the most commonly used clinical symbols to help students and healthcare providers interpret medical orders and records accurately.

Symbol	Meaning
$\bullet \text{ --- } \bullet \text{ --- } \bullet$	Dots ($\bullet$) represent a dose or tablet Dashes (---) represent meals (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner) Take 1 tablet before/after breakfast, 1 before/after lunch, and 1 before/after dinner (3 times daily around meals)
$1 - 1 - 1$	Represents <u>Morning – Afternoon – Night</u> Take 1 tablet three times a day
$\#$	Represents the total quantity to dispense (e.g., #30 means supply 30 tablets)
$\bar{c}$	With (e.g., $\bar{c}$ food = take with food).
$\bar{s}$	Without (e.g., $\bar{s}$ food = take on an empty stomach)
$\bar{s}\bar{s}$	Half (e.g., take $\bar{s}\bar{s}$ tab = take 1/2 tablet)
$\bar{a}$	Before
$\bar{p}$	After



LIST OF ABBREVIATED TERMS

Abbreviated terms are widely used in medical documentation to communicate dosage, administration routes, diagnoses, and clinical findings efficiently. This reference compiles the most commonly used clinical symbols and abbreviations to help students and healthcare providers interpret medical orders and records accurately.

DOSAGE TIMING

Abbreviation	Meaning
OD / qd	Once daily
U, u	Unit
BD / BID	Twice daily
TDS / TID	Three times daily
QID / qds	Four times daily
AC	Before meals
PC	After meals
HS / qhs	At bedtime
SOS	If needed (once only)
PRN	As needed
STAT	Immediately
q4h, q6h, q8h	Every 4 / 6 / 8 hours
Nocte	At night
Mane	In the morning
Ad lib	As desired / freely



ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION

Abbreviation	Meaning
PO	By mouth
IV	Intravenous
IM	Intramuscular
SC / SQ	Subcutaneous
PR	Per rectum
PV	Per vaginum
SL	Sublingual
ID	Intradermal
Top / Ext	Topical / external use
NPO	Nothing by mouth
INJ	Injection
NGT	Nasogastric tube
ET	Endotracheal



DRUG FORMS

Abbreviation	Meaning
Tab	Tablet
Cap	Capsule
Syr	Syrup
Susp	Suspension
Supp	Suppository
Inj	Injection
Oint	Ointment
Sol	Solution
Gtt	Drops
Amp	Ampule
Vial	Small sealed drug container
Elix	Elixir
Patch/TD	Transdermal patch

VITALS

Abbreviation	Meaning
BP	Blood pressure
HR	Heart rate
RR	Respiratory rate
TEMP/T	Temperature
SpO ₂	Oxygen Saturation
BMI	Body mass index
I/O	Intake/Output



DIAGNOSES

Abbreviation	Meaning
HTN	Hypertension
DM	Diabetes mellitus
T1DM / T2DM	Type 1 / Type 2 diabetes mellitus
CAD	Coronary artery disease
CHF	Congestive heart failure
COPD	Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease
CKD	Chronic kidney disease
UTI	Urinary tract infection
URI	Upper respiratory infection
GERD	Gastroesophageal reflux disease
AKI	Acute kidney injury
MI	Myocardial infarction
CVA	Cerebrovascular accident (stroke)
DVT	Deep vein thrombosis
PE	Pulmonary embolism
PNA	Pneumonia
TB	Tuberculosis



LAB AND TESTS

Abbreviation	Meaning
CBC	Complete blood count
RBS	Random blood sugar
FBS	Fasting blood sugar
LFT	Liver function test
RFT / KFT	Renal/kidney function test
ECG/EKG	Electrocardiogram
CXR	Chest X-ray
USG	Ultrasonography
ABG	Arterial blood gas
ESR	Erythrocyte sedimentation rate
CRP	C-reactive protein
INR	International normalized ratio



OTHERS

Abbreviation	Meaning
Sx	Symptoms
Tx	Treatment
Fx	Fracture
PMH	Past medical history
FH	Family history
SH	Social history
O/E	On examination
c/o	Complains of
NAD	No abnormality detected
WNL	Within normal limits
f/u	Follow-up
Wt / Ht	Weight / Height
D/C	Discharge (or discontinue — ambiguous, flagged by ISMP)
ADV	Advised (used to note that a test)
BERA	Brainstem Evoked Response Audiometry — tests brainstem's response to sound; used to assess hearing, esp. in infants
OAE	Otoacoustic Emissions — screens hearing by measuring inner ear's sound "echoes"; common in newborn screening
CT	Computed Tomography — cross-sectional X-ray imaging
MRI	Magnetic Resonance Imaging — imaging using magnetic fields, no radiation
Hx	History
Dx	Diagnosis
Rx	Prescription



Pamantasan ng Lungsod ng Maynila



PSH	Past medical history
ref	Referred
OPD	Outpatient department
IPD	Inpatient department
ER/ED	Emergency room/department
NKDA	No known drug allergies
NKA	No known allergies
s/p	Status post
PT	It can be patient, pregnancy test, prothrombin time
LMP	last menstrual period
AOG/GA	Age of gestation/ Gestational age



REFERENCES

Institute for Safe Medication Practices (ISMP). (2024). ISMP List of Error-Prone Abbreviations, Symbols, and Dose Designations. Horsham, PA: ISMP. Retrieved from <https://home.ecri.org/blogs/ismpr-resources/list-of-error-prone-abbreviations>

The Joint Commission. Official "Do Not Use" List (Information Management Standard IM.02.02.01). Oakbrook Terrace, IL: The Joint Commission. Retrieved from <https://www.jointcommission.org>

Geeky Medics. Common Abbreviations in Medical Notes. Retrieved from <https://geekymedics.com/common-abbreviations-in-medical-notes/>

Loyola University Chicago, Stritch School of Medicine. Clinical Abbreviations & Glossary. Retrieved from https://www.stritch.luc.edu/lumen/meded/ipm/ipm2/homepage/clinical_abbreviations_and_glossary.pdf

Prepared by:

Validated by:

MATANGA, SOPHIA VIEN
Researcher

YUPANO, DENESSE ADRIELLE P.
Researcher